

Ashcombe Advisory Partners LLC

www.ashcombeadvisory.com

July 13, 2021

Megan Sutton
Director of Operations
Lee, Rice and Adams

Dear Ms. Sutton:

Thank you for the confidence you have placed in us over the past few days. This letter confirms the terms on which our firm will support Lee, Rice and Adams through the current matter, and it should be read alongside the conversation we had when you first called. If any part of it sits differently from what we discussed, tell me and we will set it right before either of us signs.

The Work Before Us

Our task is to help Lee, Rice and Adams respond to the present situation clearly, quickly, and with a single voice, and then to steady the firm's standing once the immediate pressure has eased. We treat a matter like this for what it is, a communications problem laid over a real set of facts, and we will not let the message run ahead of what you can stand behind.

The audiences that matter here are distinct rather than many: your clients and referral sources, your own people, the press that follows the firm, and the wider professional community whose regard the firm depends on. Each will read the same facts a little differently, and part of our job is to see that the firm speaks to each in a way that is true, consistent, and mindful of the others listening in.

In practice, that means preparing the holding language and the fuller statements you may need at short notice, deciding who should say what to which audience and in what order, and keeping a close watch on how the matter is being reported and discussed. It also means readying the people who will speak for the firm, so that when a hard question comes they answer it the same way and without surprise.

Our method is deliberately calm. We begin by getting the facts straight with you and your counsel, we agree the small number of things the firm most needs understood, and we build every message back to those. We will also settle a simple approval path at the outset, so that in a fast-moving hour it is clear who can clear a statement and

who must be told; speed matters in a crisis, and the path is there so that quick does not become careless.

The People You Will Work With

I will keep this account in my own hands and be your point of contact for anything sensitive or urgent while the matter is active. On the statements that carry the most weight, nothing will go out without my sign-off.

Amy Carter will run the work day to day, holding the thread together, turning our conversations into drafts, and making sure a promised follow-up actually reaches you. She is steady under a tight clock and easy to reach.

Nancy Suarez will keep the moving parts in order, shepherding approvals, tracking the timeline, and seeing that every version is logged and current. Between the two of them, you will always know where a piece of work stands.

Fees and Payment

Our fee for the engagement is \$46,500, covering the work described above and the counsel of the team through the period. We have set it as a fixed fee so that you can call on us as the matter demands without watching a clock.

The fee covers our people and their time. It does not cover out-of-pocket costs such as travel, media monitoring taken in your name, or third-party services you ask us to arrange; those we pass through at cost and only with your agreement in advance. We invoice monthly, payable within thirty days.

Commencement and Term

The engagement begins July 23, 2021 and is expected to run about eight months, which reflects both the active phase of the matter and the quieter work of rebuilding afterward. If the situation resolves sooner, we will say so and wind the work down rather than fill the time.

Either of us may end the engagement on fourteen days' written notice. If you bring it to a close, you owe us for the work done and the costs committed to that point, and we will hand over our files and working materials so that nothing is left stranded.

Confidentiality

Everything we learn about Lee, Rice and Adams, the matter, and the people involved we will hold in strict confidence and use only for the purpose of this engagement.

Given the nature of the work, we will also be careful with our own internal handling, keeping the account on a need-to-know footing within the firm.

Limitation of Liability

We will do this work with the care and skill you are entitled to expect from an experienced adviser, and we stand behind it. We are advisers on communications, though, not on the law or on the underlying facts, and our liability to you under this engagement is limited to the fees paid under it. We do not warrant any particular outcome in the press, in the market, or before any other audience.

Governing Law

This agreement is governed by the law of the state in which our firm is established, and any dispute under it will be resolved there. Nothing in it displaces the duty we owe you as your communications adviser.

If this reflects our understanding, please sign below and return one copy to me, keeping the other for your records. Once it is back, Amy Carter will send the kickoff note and we will begin.

Julie Hill

Managing Partner
Date: July 13, 2021

Megan Sutton

Director of Operations, Lee, Rice and Adams
Date: July 13, 2021